

LUCIDPREP

Grade 9 Social Studies Curriculum

U.S. Standards-Aligned Course Syllabus

SOCIAL STUDIES

World History

36 weeks • 4 modules • 70% mastery

Curriculum Architecture

This course is organized as 36 weeks across four 9-week modules. Every week follows LucidPrep's established secondary learning cycle: AI Instructor opening, objectives, vocabulary, five warm-ups, main lecture, two short tutorial videos, AI Instructor presentation, two homework sets, and a 40-question assessment.

Mastery standard: 70%+. Students below mastery review the instructional presentation and may retake the assessment, matching the existing LucidPrep secondary model.

U.S. Alignment Note

The U.S. does not have one national Grade 9 social studies sequence. Grade 9 is most often World History (a full chronological survey) or, in some states, World Geography or a two-year Global History & Geography sequence. This curriculum builds a World History course on the C3 Framework inquiry arc as the primary national reference, with the Common Core literacy standards for history/social studies, and cross-checks themes against state frameworks. Course placement varies by district, so this is presented as a U.S. Standards-Aligned Grade 9 course.

Prepared for LucidPrep • Curriculum Planning Edition • 2026

Common Instructional & Assessment Model

Weekly Learning Cycle

Step	Component	Description
1	Opening / Domain Overview	~2-minute AI Instructor introduction
2	Objectives + Vocabulary	Student-facing outcomes and core terminology
3	Warm-Up	5 questions with explanations
4	Main Lecture	Concept instruction, models and examples
5	Video Tutorials	2 short instructional videos
6	AI Instructor Presentation	Visual models, examples, strategies and applications
7	Homework	Two sets of 5 questions
8	Weekly Assessment	40 questions; 70% mastery
9	Review / Retake	Below mastery → review presentation → retake

Assessment Philosophy

Questions should emphasize reasoning, explanation, source analysis, interpretation of maps and data, application to unfamiliar situations, and evidence-based argument rather than recall alone. Each module assessment should sample all major concepts and include document-based, scenario and constructed-response items.

This 36-week course is designed around the **C3 Framework Dimensions 1-4 (History, Geography, Civics, Economics) with CCSS literacy for history/social studies (RH.9-10, WHST.9-10)**. It is a full-year curriculum with four nine-week modules and a consistent LucidPrep mastery workflow.

Grade	9
Course	World History
Duration	36 weeks
Structure	4 modules × 9 weeks
Weekly assessment	40 questions
Mastery threshold	70%
Module assessments	Weeks 9, 18, 27
Final assessment	Week 36

Course Learning Outcomes

- Trace major developments in world history from early civilizations to the present.
- Apply historical thinking — chronology, causation, continuity and change, and context.
- Use geography, civics and economics concepts to analyze societies.
- Evaluate primary and secondary sources and construct evidence-based arguments.
- Communicate conclusions and consider informed civic action.

Social Studies

Module 1 — Foundations: Early & Classical Civilizations

Week	Topics	Students will be able to	Standards
Week 1 — Thinking Like a Historian	Historical inquiry; chronology; primary vs. secondary sources; cause and effect; periodization; maps	Analyze sources; reason chronologically and spatially	C3 D1/D3; RH.9-10.1
Week 2 — Human Origins & the Neolithic Revolution	Paleolithic era; hunter-gatherers; agriculture; domestication; first settlements	Explain how agriculture transformed human societies	C3 D2 His/Geo
Week 3 — River Valley Civilizations	Mesopotamia; Egypt; Indus Valley; early China; cities; writing; law codes; social structure	Compare early civilizations and their innovations	C3 D2 His/Geo
Week 4 — Classical Greece	City-states; Athenian democracy; philosophy; Persian and Peloponnesian wars; Hellenism	Analyze Greek contributions to government and thought	C3 D2 Civ/His
Week 5 — Classical Rome	Republic to empire; Roman law; engineering; Pax Romana; causes of Rome's decline	Explain Rome's rise, achievements and fall	C3 D2 Civ/His
Week 6 — Classical India & China	Maurya and Gupta empires; Han dynasty; Silk Road origins; Mandate of Heaven; Confucianism and Legalism	Analyze classical Asian empires and philosophies	C3 D2 His/Geo
Week 7 — World Belief Systems	Hinduism; Buddhism; Judaism; Christianity; Confucianism and Daoism — origins, beliefs, spread	Compare major belief systems and how they spread	C3 D2 His
Week 8 — Trade, Technology & Cultural Diffusion	Early trade networks; Silk Roads; cultural exchange; spread of ideas, goods and disease	Explain how trade spread goods, ideas and technology	C3 D2 Geo/Econ
Week 9 — Module Assessment	Integrated review of early and classical civilizations, belief systems and trade	Synthesize concepts; demonstrate 70%+ mastery	Performance assessment

Module delivery notes. Anchor each unit in an inquiry arc built on compelling and supporting questions. Use primary and secondary sources, maps and data heavily, and emphasize causation, continuity and change, and multiple perspectives over memorization of isolated names and dates.

Social Studies

Module 2 — Postclassical World: Empires, Trade & Belief (c. 500-1500)

Week	Topics	Students will be able to	Standards
Week 1 — Rise of Islam & Islamic Empires	Origins of Islam; the caliphates; Golden Age of learning; trade and expansion	Analyze the rise and achievements of Islamic civilization	C3 D2 His/Geo
Week 2 — Medieval Europe & Feudalism	Aftermath of Rome; feudalism; manorialism; the Church; Charlemagne	Explain feudal society and the role of the Church	C3 D2 Civ/Econ
Week 3 — Byzantine Empire & Eastern Europe	Byzantine Empire; Justinian; Orthodox Christianity; Kievan Rus	Analyze the Byzantine legacy and its influence	C3 D2 His
Week 4 — East Asian Empires	Tang and Song China; innovations; feudal Japan and the samurai; Korea	Analyze East Asian political and cultural achievements	C3 D2 His
Week 5 — African Kingdoms & Trade	Ghana, Mali and Songhai; trans-Saharan trade; Mansa Musa; the Swahili coast	Explain the wealth and trade networks of African states	C3 D2 Geo/Econ
Week 6 — Civilizations of the Americas	Maya, Aztec and Inca; achievements; agriculture; social and political organization	Compare pre-Columbian American civilizations	C3 D2 His/Geo
Week 7 — The Mongols & Eurasian Interconnection	Mongol conquests; Pax Mongolica; expanded Eurasian trade and exchange	Evaluate the Mongols' impact on Eurasian connection	C3 D2 His/Geo
Week 8 — Crisis & Change in the Late Middle Ages	The Crusades; the Black Death; decline of feudalism; growth of towns and trade	Analyze causes and effects of late-medieval crises	C3 D2 His/Econ
Week 9 — Module Assessment	Postclassical empires, trade networks, belief systems and crises	Synthesize concepts; demonstrate 70%+ mastery	Performance assessment

Module delivery notes. Anchor each unit in an inquiry arc built on compelling and supporting questions. Use primary and secondary sources, maps and data heavily, and emphasize causation, continuity and change, and multiple perspectives over memorization of isolated names and dates.

Social Studies

Module 3 — Connecting the World: Renaissance to Revolutions (c. 1300–1815)

Week	Topics	Students will be able to	Standards
Week 1 — The Renaissance	Humanism; art and ideas; spread from Italy; the printing press	Explain how the Renaissance reshaped European thought	C3 D2 His
Week 2 — The Reformation	Luther and Protestantism; Catholic Reformation; religious wars; political effects	Analyze causes and consequences of the Reformation	C3 D2 His/Civ
Week 3 — Age of Exploration	Motives; navigation technology; Portuguese and Spanish voyages; new sea routes	Explain the causes and reach of European exploration	C3 D2 Geo/Econ
Week 4 — Columbian Exchange & Global Encounters	Exchange of goods, people and disease; conquest of the Americas; early colonization	Analyze the impact of the Columbian Exchange	C3 D2 Geo/Econ
Week 5 — The Transatlantic Slave Trade	Origins; the Middle Passage; plantation economies; impact on Africa and the Americas	Evaluate the causes and human impact of the slave trade	C3 D2 His/Econ
Week 6 — Absolutism & Global Empires	Absolute monarchs; Ottoman, Mughal and Safavid empires; Ming and Qing China	Compare forms of centralized power across the world	C3 D2 Civ/His
Week 7 — Scientific Revolution & Enlightenment	New science and reason; Enlightenment thinkers; ideas of government and natural rights	Analyze Enlightenment ideas about society and government	C3 D2 Civ/His
Week 8 — The Age of Revolutions	American, French, Haitian and Latin American revolutions; rise of nationalism	Compare causes and outcomes of the Atlantic revolutions	C3 D2 Civ/His
Week 9 — Module Assessment	Renaissance, Reformation, global encounters and the Age of Revolutions	Synthesize concepts; demonstrate 70%+ mastery	Performance assessment

Module delivery notes. Anchor each unit in an inquiry arc built on compelling and supporting questions. Use primary and secondary sources, maps and data heavily, and emphasize causation, continuity and change, and multiple perspectives over memorization of isolated names and dates.

Social Studies

Module 4 — The Modern World: Industrialization to Globalization (c. 1800-present)

Week	Topics	Students will be able to	Standards
Week 1 — The Industrial Revolution	Origins; technology; the factory system; urbanization; social and economic change	Analyze causes and effects of industrialization	C3 D2 Econ/His
Week 2 — Nationalism & Imperialism	Rise of nation-states; “new imperialism”; scramble for Africa and Asia; resistance	Explain motives and consequences of imperialism	C3 D2 Civ/Geo
Week 3 — World War I	Long- and short-term causes; total war; new technology; Russian Revolution; peace settlement	Analyze the causes and global impact of WWI	C3 D2 His/Civ
Week 4 — Between the Wars	The Great Depression; rise of totalitarianism — fascism, communism and Nazism	Explain conditions that enabled totalitarian regimes	C3 D2 Civ/Econ
Week 5 — World War II	Causes; major events and theaters; the Holocaust; home fronts; consequences	Analyze the causes, course and human cost of WWII	C3 D2 His/Civ
Week 6 — The Cold War	Superpower rivalry; containment; proxy wars; the nuclear age; end of the Cold War	Explain the global Cold War rivalry and its effects	C3 D2 Civ/Geo
Week 7 — Decolonization & Movements for Rights	End of empires; new independent nations; civil-rights and human-rights movements	Analyze decolonization and struggles for rights	C3 D2 Civ/His
Week 8 — Globalization & the Contemporary World	Global economy; technology; migration; environment; human rights; current issues	Evaluate globalization; consider evidence-based civic action	C3 D2/D4 Econ/Geo
Week 9 — Final Assessment	Full-course synthesis: ancient foundations → connected world → modern era	Solve unfamiliar source-based problems; demonstrate mastery	Final performance assessment

Module delivery notes. Anchor each unit in an inquiry arc built on compelling and supporting questions. Use primary and secondary sources, maps and data heavily, and emphasize causation, continuity and change, and multiple perspectives over memorization of isolated names and dates.

Assessment & Alignment

Assessment Blueprint

Warm-ups: weekly • Homework: weekly • Weekly assessment: 40 questions • Module assessments: Weeks 9 / 18 / 27 • Final: Week 36 • Below 70%: instructional review and retake.

Standards Alignment

Primary framework	C3 Framework Dimensions 1–4 (History, Geography, Civics, Economics); CCSS literacy RH.9–10 & WHST.9–10
Social Studies Practices	Developing questions & planning inquiry; gathering and evaluating sources; using evidence; chronological and spatial reasoning; causation and argumentation; communicating conclusions; taking informed action
Recurring Concepts	Continuity & change; cause & effect; power & authority; movement & interaction; belief systems; conflict & cooperation; economic systems
State mapping	California History–Social Science, New York Global History & Geography, and Texas TEKS can be mapped at chapter / question level without changing the core 36-week structure.

Content Production Guidance

For each week, expand the syllabus topic into the established LucidPrep package: ~2-minute opening, objectives, vocabulary, 5 warm-ups with explanations, lecture, 2 ~2-minute videos, AI Instructor presentation, two homework sets of 5, 40-question assessment, answer explanations and mastery/retake handling. Build question banks around primary sources, maps, scenarios, data and argument.

Curriculum Basis & Source Notes

This document is a U.S.-aligned curriculum architecture, not a claim of a single nationwide Grade 9 sequence. Grade 9 social studies is most commonly World History, though some states use World Geography or a Global History & Geography sequence; placement and titles vary by state and district.

Primary reference	C3 Framework for Social Studies State Standards (College, Career, and Civic Life) — the inquiry arc (Dimensions 1–4) and disciplinary concepts in Civics, Economics, Geography and History.
Literacy reference	Common Core State Standards for Literacy in History/Social Studies, grades 9–10 (Reading in History/Social Studies, RH.9-10; Writing for History/Social Studies, WHST.9-10).
State cross-check	California History–Social Science Framework and New York State Global History & Geography framework (grades 9–10).
State cross-check	Texas Education Agency TEKS — World History Studies and World Geography Studies (note: Texas places World Geography in Grade 9 and World History in Grade 10); themes can be mapped without changing the 36-week structure.
LucidPrep product alignment	36-week / four-module secondary architecture, weekly instructional components, 40-question assessments, 70% mastery, and review/retake pathway.

Recommended next production step. Add standards metadata to each chapter and question (C3 dimension and disciplinary indicators, plus RH/WHST literacy codes and state-framework identifiers) so LucidPrep can support multiple U.S. state alignments without duplicating the course.